

Privacy Policy

Apps for Change · A Minnesota 501(c)(3) Nonprofit Corporation

Effective date: 10/24/26
v5 · October 24, 2026

Privacy at a glance

- Our apps are free and have no ads.
- We never sell your information or use it for advertising.
- We never share your entries with employers, insurers, funders, or partner organizations.
- Your entries are stored securely in your account in the cloud, so they’re there when you get a new phone.
- Our team doesn’t read your entries, except to help with a support request you send us, when the law requires it, or to investigate a security problem.
- Only one app uses AI, and only when you ask: Advocate’s Compass writes a script when you request one.
- Surveys, reminder emails, calendar access, and AI are all optional.
- You can delete any entry, or your whole account, at any time.

1. Who We Are

Apps for Change is a Minnesota nonprofit corporation, tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. We build free mobile apps that help people reach their goals, show kindness to others and to themselves, get through cravings, and speak up for themselves. As a nonprofit with no owners, we have no reason to sell your data, and we never will.

This Privacy Policy explains what information we collect, how we use and protect it, and the choices you have. It covers:

- Our four mobile apps: Goal Getter, Care About You, Beat the Craving, and Advocate's Compass, including test versions before each launch
- Our website, appsforchange.org
- The other ways you connect with us, such as email, our newsletter, donations, town halls, focus groups, and private testing

"We," "us," and "our" mean Apps for Change. "You" means anyone who uses our apps or website or connects with us in these ways.

2. How Each App Handles Your Information

Each app uses an account. Your entries are stored in your account on our secure cloud servers, so your information is there when you get a new phone or use more than one device.

App	Uses AI?	May ask your permission for
Goal Getter	No	Calendar, to add the steps you choose; notifications, for reminders
Care About You	No	Calendar, to add the plans you choose
Beat the Craving	No	Nothing. It never sends notifications.
Advocate's Compass	Only when you ask Advocate Now for a script	Notifications

None of our apps asks for your contacts, photos, or files. None asks for your location, either.



Goal Getter

Goal Getter stores the goals you set and your plans to reach them. This may include your goals and the life areas they belong to, action steps, milestones, due dates, reminders, check-ins, reflections, and your progress.

- **Your calendar (optional).** Goal Getter adds your steps and milestones to your phone's calendar. It asks your permission first and adds only what you choose.

- **Milestone emails (optional).** If you turn them on, Goal Getter emails your account email address a note to celebrate a milestone.
- **No AI.** Goal Getter has no AI features.



Care About You

Care About You stores your plans to show kindness to the people in your life and to yourself. This may include the names you type in, short notes about the people you add (such as what they love to do), the acts of kindness you plan and complete, ideas you save for later, dates and times, and your monthly recap. You add people yourself. The app doesn't read your phone's contacts.

- **No AI.** Care About You doesn't use AI. If we ever add AI suggestions, we'll update this policy before they start, and they'll run only when you ask.
- **Your calendar (optional).** Care About You asks your permission before it adds anything to your phone's calendar, and it adds only the plans you choose. It doesn't read or copy the other events on your calendar. Once a plan is on your calendar, your calendar app stores it, along with any service it syncs with, such as iCloud or Google Calendar. You can turn off calendar access at any time in your phone's settings.
- **Email reminders (optional).** If you set them up, we email reminders about upcoming plans to your account email address. You can turn them off at any time.

You don't need to share private details about anyone. A first name and a few words are enough.



Beat the Craving

Beat the Craving stores the tools and notes that help you get through cravings. This may include the coping strategies you choose, edit, or add; your days-in-recovery counter; the cravings you log and your cravings-beaten counter; and notes about your triggers, such as the time, the place, the people, or the feeling, which the app uses to show you patterns.

- **No AI.** Beat the Craving has no AI features, so your entries are never sent to an AI provider.
- **No notifications.** Beat the Craving never sends notifications, so nothing about it pops up on your lock screen.
- **Your progress stays with you.** The app has no way to share your counters, notes, or progress with other people.
- **Outside help, one tap away.** Some coping strategies open outside help. The AA button calls AA or opens an outside meeting finder. Calls go through your phone, and outside services have their own privacy policies.
- **Keep it private on your phone.** Anyone who can open your phone can open the app, so use your phone's screen lock.
- **Sensitive by default.** We treat everything you enter in Beat the Craving as sensitive. See Section 8.



Advocate's Compass

Advocate's Compass stores what you learn and the plans you make to speak up for yourself. This may include lessons and practice you've finished, upcoming meetings, what you want to say and ask, notes on what was decided and who will do what, and your Advocate Now requests and scripts.

- **Advocate Now (optional AI).** When you ask Advocate Now for a script, we send what you type to our AI provider to write it. Nothing is sent unless you ask. See Section 5.
- **Personal by nature.** Notes about health, disability, services and benefits, housing, work, or a child's school can be sensitive. We protect them that way. See Section 8.

Short surveys in every app

From time to time, each app may ask a few short questions, such as how prepared you felt after a meeting or how you've been feeling lately. Answering is always up to you, and skipping a survey doesn't change how the app works for you. We use the answers only in totals, as described in Section 4.

3. What Information We Collect

We collect only what we need to run our apps, website, and programs.

Information you give us

- **Account information.** Your email address, a name or username, and your password or other sign-in details. If you choose to sign in with Apple or Google, they share your name and email address with us.
- **App content.** The entries you make in our apps, described in Section 2, and your app settings, such as reminder choices.
- **Survey answers.** Your answers to the optional surveys in our apps.
- **Messages to us.** What you send when you email us for support, ask for launch updates, sign up for a town hall or a private test, share an idea, or give feedback.
- **Newsletter.** Your email address, and your first name if you give it, when you sign up for our newsletter.
- **Town halls and focus groups.** Your name (a first name is fine), your email address, and what you choose to share. We never record town halls. We record a focus group only with every participant's consent, and we use recordings only for our internal notes.
- **Private testing.** If you test an app before it launches, your name, your email address, and the feedback you send us.
- **Donations.** If you donate on our website, our payment processor, Stripe, handles your payment. We receive details such as your name, email address, and the amount and date of

your gift, so we can send your receipt and keep required records. We never receive your full card number.

Information collected automatically

- **Device information.** Your device type, operating system version, and app version, so the app works properly.
- **Log information.** When an app connects to our servers, our app host's systems record basic technical details, such as your IP address, the time, and the type of request. We use these to keep our services running and secure.
- **Crash and error reports.** If an app has a problem, we may receive a report about what went wrong. Some reports come from Apple or Google, if you've allowed your phone to share them with app developers.
- **Website visits.** See Section 13.

Information we don't collect

- Your precise location
- Your phone's contacts, photos, or files
- Advertising IDs or advertising profiles
- Your payment card number (Stripe handles payments)

4. How We Use Your Information

We use your information only to:

- Create and manage your account and let you sign in
- Store your entries securely and make them available on your devices
- Provide the features you choose, such as calendar plans, reminders, the emails you turn on, and the scripts you ask Advocate Now to write
- Fix bugs, improve our apps, and keep our services secure
- Answer your questions and support requests
- Send the launch updates, newsletters, town hall details, and other messages you ask for
- Run town halls, focus groups, and private tests
- Process donations, send receipts, and keep required records
- Measure our impact and report it to funders and our Board, using totals only
- Follow the law

We don't use your information for advertising, and we don't sell, rent, or trade it. We never use your entries to ask you for donations, and we never use them to train AI. We don't share your entries or survey answers with outside researchers or evaluators. If that ever changes, we'll ask for your permission first.

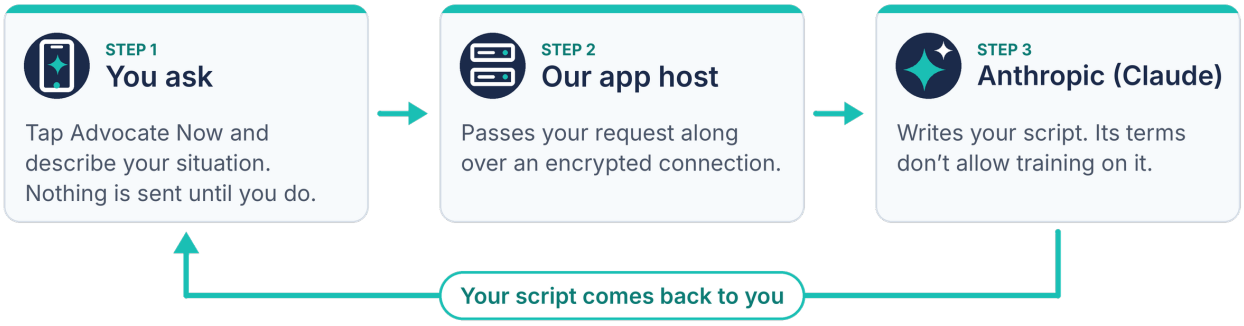
How we measure our impact

To learn whether our apps really help, we look at totals across everyone who uses them, such as how many people use each app, how many milestones get completed, how many cravings people get through, and the combined results of our optional surveys. These totals are counted automatically. Nobody on our team reads your entries to make them. When we report to funders, our Board, or the public, we share only totals that can't identify anyone.

5. How Our AI Feature Works

Only one of our apps has an AI feature, and it runs only when you ask.

App	When AI runs	What we send to our AI provider
Advocate's Compass	When you ask Advocate Now for a script	What you type to describe your situation
Goal Getter	Never	Nothing
Care About You	Never	Nothing
Beat the Craving	Never	Nothing



- **Who receives it.** Our AI provider is Anthropic, the company that makes Claude. Your request goes through our app host to Anthropic, which uses it to write your script and send it back.
- **Not used to train AI.** Anthropic's commercial terms don't allow it to train its AI models on content sent through its services. Our app host doesn't keep what you send or use it to train AI, either.
- **Your choice.** If you don't ask Advocate Now for a script, nothing is sent to our AI provider.
- **Share only what's needed.** Leave out details the AI doesn't need, like last names, diagnoses, ID numbers (such as a Social Security or Medicaid number), account numbers, or case numbers.
- **AI can make mistakes.** Scripts are a starting point. You know your situation best.
- **No AI elsewhere without notice.** Before any of our other apps uses AI, we'll update this policy and tell you, and the AI will run only when you ask.

6. How We Share Your Information

We share information only in the limited ways described here.

Service providers

We use a small number of trusted providers to run our apps, website, and programs. They store or process information for us under written agreements that let them use it only to provide their services to us and require them to protect it.

Provider	What they do for us	What they may receive
Our app host, (app.specular.dev)	Runs our apps' servers, database, and account sign-in, and sends the app emails you turn on.	Account information, app content, survey answers, and log information
Anthropic	Writes the Advocate Now scripts you ask for	Only what you type into an Advocate Now request (Section 5)
Google (Google Workspace for Nonprofits)	Runs our email, our forms, and our town hall video meetings on Google Meet that email and forms run on Google Workspace	Messages and form responses you send us, and your name and email address when you join a town hall
Our newsletter service, Brevo	Sends our newsletter and launch updates	Your email address, and your first name if you give it
Stripe	Processes donations on our website	The payment and contact details you enter when you donate
Our website host, Vercel	Runs appsforchange.org	Basic website visit information

Apple and Google run the app stores and your phone's operating system. If you test an app before it launches, Apple's TestFlight or Google Play's testing program delivers the test version and may share your name, email address, crash reports, and any feedback you send through it with us. Their own privacy policies cover how they handle information, including app downloads and notifications.

Legal requirements and safety

We may disclose information if required by law, subpoena, or court order, or if we believe in good faith that disclosure is needed to protect someone's life or safety. Where the law allows, we'll try to tell you before we disclose your information in response to a legal demand.

If our organization changes

If Apps for Change ever dissolves or transfers its programs, any transfer of user information would go only to another charitable organization or public body, as our bylaws require, and only on terms that protect your information consistent with this policy. We'll tell you first, so you can get a copy of your information or delete your account.

What we never do

- Sell your personal information, to anyone, for any purpose
- Share your entries or survey answers with employers, insurers, funders, or partner organizations
- Use your information for advertising
- Show your entries to other people. Our apps have no social features. If we ever add a way to share with others, it will be optional, and we'll update this policy before it starts.

7. How We Store and Protect Your Information

Your account information and app content are stored on secure cloud servers run by our app host, located in the United States. If you use our apps from another country, your information will be stored and processed there.

We protect your information with reasonable administrative, technical, and physical safeguards, including:

- Encryption of your information while it travels between your device and our servers and while it's stored, once the host confirms encryption at rest
- Access limited to the few people who need it to run and support our apps
- A firm rule that our team doesn't read your entries, except when you ask us to help with a support issue, when the law requires it, or when we need to investigate a security problem

No system is perfectly secure. Please use a strong password that you don't use anywhere else, and use your phone's screen lock. If a security incident affects your personal information, we'll notify you and the appropriate authorities as the law requires.

> **Need help right now?**
> Our apps aren't for emergencies, and our team doesn't monitor what you enter in them.
>
> - In an emergency, call 911 or your local emergency number.
> - In the U.S., call or text 988 to reach the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, free and open 24/7.
> - For free, confidential treatment referrals, call SAMHSA's National Helpline at 1-800-662-4357, open 24/7 in English and Spanish.

8. Sensitive Information

Some entries are more personal than others. We treat these as sensitive:

- Everything in **Beat the Craving**, which may relate to substance use, recovery, or emotional well-being
- Entries in **Advocate's Compass** about health, disability, services and benefits, housing, work, legal matters, or a child's school

- Your answers to optional surveys about well-being, loneliness, or recovery
- Health, mental health, or other personal details you choose to write in **Goal Getter** or **Care About You**

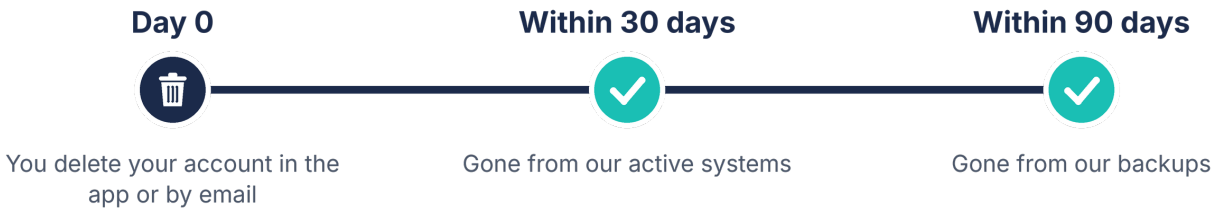
We use this information only to run the app for you and, in totals that can't identify anyone, to measure our impact. We never sell it, use it for advertising, or share it with partner organizations, funders, employers, or insurers. Beat the Craving entries are never sent to an AI provider. From Advocate's Compass, only what you type into an Advocate Now request is sent, and only when you ask.

9. Information About Other People

Care About You and Advocate's Compass let you write about other people, such as a friend you want to check in with or a child you're advocating for at school. Please include only what you need. We use this information only to run the app for you. We never contact the people you write about, sell their information, or use it for advertising.

10. Keeping and Deleting Your Information

We keep your account information and app content while your account is open, so it's there when you need it.



- **Delete entries anytime.** You can delete any entry inside the app.
- **Delete your account.** Use the app's settings, or email support@appsforchange.org. We'll delete your account, app content, and survey answers from our active systems within 30 days and from backups within 90 days, unless the law requires us to keep them longer. Totals we've already counted can't identify you, so they stay in our reports.
- **Each app separately.** Each app has its own account, so deleting your account in one app doesn't delete your accounts in our other apps.
- **Uninstalling isn't deleting.** Removing an app from your phone doesn't delete your account. To erase your information, delete your account.
- **Calendar plans stay on your calendar.** Plans and steps you added to your phone's calendar stay there until you delete them in your calendar app.
- **Inactive accounts.** If an account is inactive for 24 months, we may delete it after first emailing you a notice.

- **Technical data.** We keep crash reports and logs only as long as needed to fix problems, and no longer than 12 months.
- **Messages and sign-ups.** We keep emails, support messages, and town hall and tester sign-ups for up to 3 years.
- **Newsletter.** We keep your newsletter sign-up until you unsubscribe.
- **Town hall and focus group records.** We keep summaries and consent forms for 3 years. We delete focus group recordings once our notes are finished.
- **Donation records.** We keep donation records for 7 years to meet tax and accounting requirements.
- **Records of your requests.** When you ask us to access or delete your information, we keep a record of your request and our response for 3 years after we complete it. The record never includes the deleted content.

11. Children and Teens

Our apps are for people 13 and older and aren't directed at children under 13. We don't knowingly collect personal information from children under 13, consistent with the Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA). If we learn that a child under 13 has created an account or given us personal information, we'll delete it promptly. If you think this has happened, please email support@appsforchange.org.

If you're under 18, please use our apps with a parent's or guardian's involvement and consent. Town halls are for adults, and teens 13 to 17 can join with a parent or guardian on the call. Private testing is for adults only.

12. Your Rights and Choices

You have the right to:

- **Access** the information we hold about you, and get a copy of your app content
- **Correct** inaccurate account information
- **Delete** your entries or your whole account at any time
- **Ask questions** about how we handle your information

You may have more rights under the privacy laws of the state or country where you live. To make a request, email support@appsforchange.org. We'll verify your identity to protect your account and respond within 30 days. We'll never treat you differently for using your rights.

You also have these choices:

- **Notifications.** Turn them off at any time in your phone's settings.
- **Calendar.** Turn off calendar access at any time in your phone's settings.
- **App emails.** Turn reminder and milestone emails off at any time in the app.

- **Surveys.** Answer them only if you want to.
- **AI.** Use Advocate Now only if you want to. Nothing goes to our AI provider unless you ask.
- **Newsletter and other emails from us.** Unsubscribe with the link in any newsletter, or ask us to stop sending launch updates or other messages at any time, and we will.

13. Our Website, Cookies, and Tracking

Our apps don't use advertising trackers, advertising IDs, or cross-app tracking. Our website doesn't use advertising trackers either. It may use cookies or logs needed to run the site and process donations, and basic analytics to count visits. Our newsletter doesn't track whether you open it or which links you click. We don't track you for advertising, in our apps, on our website, or in our emails.

14. Links to Other Services

Our apps and website may link to outside websites and resources, such as crisis lines, AA, and community services. Some coping strategies in Beat the Craving open these resources directly. We're not responsible for their privacy practices, so please review their policies.

15. Changes to This Policy

We may update this policy from time to time. When we do, we'll change the effective date at the top. If we make a significant change, such as adding AI to another app, adding a new kind of service provider, or adding a new way of sharing information, we'll tell you in the app or by email before it takes effect. We won't use information we've already collected in a materially different way without your consent.

16. Contact Us

Questions, concerns, or privacy requests? Contact us:

Apps for Change · A Minnesota 501(c)(3) Nonprofit Corporation
Privacy and support: support@appsforchange.org
General questions: info@appsforchange.org
Mail: 1670 S Robert St #131, West Saint Paul, MN 55118
Phone: 763-276-3958
Website: appsforchange.org

Need this policy in another format? We can send it in large print, as plain text for a screen reader, or in another format that works for you. Just email support@appsforchange.org.